Ke-Cheng Hsu (Clio)
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Peixuan Li
Associate
Econic Partners — Beijing
pli@econic.com

Dear Peixuan,

I am writing to express my interest in a Ph.D. Associate role with Econic Partners in Beijing. Muyang mentioned that the Beijing office is recruiting Ph.D. Associates. I am a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at HKUST specializing in empirical industrial organization and digital economics, native in Mandarin and professionally fluent in English.

My research centers on using large proprietary datasets to analyze welfare and conduct counterfactual analysis. In "Too Much Unsold Stock?," joint with Kei Kawai (Senior Consultant, Compass Lexecon) and Kohei Kawaguchi (Advisor, UTokyo Economic Consulting Inc.), we study whether resale price maintenance is pro-competitive by encouraging sellers to hold inventory, and how much unsold stock is an environmental cost of price commitment. Estimating a dynamic oligopoly model on monthly bookstore data, we find that the classical static model overestimates marginal cost by ∼20% when ignoring dynamic demand uncertainty and inventory decisions. Through this collaboration, I learned to communicate clearly and rigorously with data: cleaning and transforming raw records, then using descriptive statistics, regression, and data visualization to convey the central idea before turning to structural models, and to explain key intuition with simple, easy-to-understand graphs.

My job market paper studies return policy as a trade-off between purchase and return efficiency: a stricter return policy curbs inefficient ex-post returns, but the resulting lower return rates make higher prices more attractive for sellers and can exclude ex-ante efficient purchases. Empirically, automatic provision of return-shipping insurance performs better in high-margin categories by expanding valuable purchases, while selective adoption of return-shipping insurance outperforms automatic provision by ∼15–30 percentage points of first-best welfare in thinner-margin categories by curbing excessive returns; a partial return-penalty discount (discounted price + ∼10–15% restocking fee) beats both outside dresses, attaining ∼75–78% of first-best welfare. I build reproducible pipelines on AWS and HPC/SLURM in Python, R, and C++, and write tests to ensure clarity and rigor; I am comfortable with GMM, instrumental variables, bootstrap inference, and counterfactual welfare analysis. In Ph.D.-level industrial organization coursework, I also conducted merger simulation, market entry/exit counterfactuals, and identification of firm conduct parameters.

Although my CV lists an expected graduation of June 2027, if an offer is available I can accelerate completion and join as early as November or December for a Ph.D. Associate or Analyst role. I am also open to an Intern position; for that, timing may need to wait until next year, or I could start remotely if helpful. I have attached my CV and transcript, and included my GitHub (github.com/cliohsu1997). I can provide my job market paper upon request. Thank you very much for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Ke-Cheng Hsu (Clio)